

To: Prof. Yoav Goldberg

Email: yoav.goldberg@biu.ac.il

Subject: Application for PhD in NLP (Bar-Ilan NLP Lab — Goldberg group) — Ref [TODO: verify with user] — Nauval Zulfikar

Dear Prof. Goldberg,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD position within the Bar-Ilan NLP Lab under your supervision. I am particularly drawn to the opportunity to work on projects that align with your research themes in multilingual NLP and transformer analysis. I am available to start the program on 1 September 2026.

Your paper, "[TODO: verify supervisor paper title via Google Scholar]", has been instrumental in shaping my understanding of the intricacies of word embeddings and their applications in multilingual contexts. The depth of analysis and innovative approaches presented in your work inspire my application, as I am eager to contribute to advancing this field.

During my MSc in Business Analytics at Aston University, I focused on projects that resonate with the themes of your lab. My dissertation, "*Enhancing Supply Chain Information Sharing Systems Through Blockchain: Integrated Customer Reviews LLM Analysis: A Smart Contract Approach*", involved fine-tuning the DeBERTa-v3 transformer for behavioural text analysis, which aligns with your interest in transformer analysis. Additionally, my project, *CV-JD Suitability Checker*, utilised DeBERTa-v3 for semantic matching, demonstrating my capability in transformer fine-tuning and NLP.

While my background is in Business Analytics rather than pure Computer Science, I have developed a strong foundation in NLP and deep learning through both formal education and practical projects. My work as a Data Scientist and Project Manager at the Public Works & Spatial Planning Department involved developing ETL pipelines and dashboards, which honed my skills in data governance and model reliability.

I have attached my CV and transcripts for your review. I am enthusiastic about the possibility of discussing how my background, skills, and enthusiasms align with the goals of your lab.

Sincerely,

Nauval Zulfikar

zulfikar.nauval1998@gmail.com | +44 7300 469048